THE BELLS BENEATH BRACKENFORD

Kael Drakeshield | Session 1

Arrival in Brackenford

Location: Brackenford, northern frontier of the Kingdom of Aurel.

Arrived in Brackenford late afternoon. Fairly large frontier settlement, surrounded by farmland and dense woodland. An old stone bell tower stands in the centre of town. Apparently dates back to the founding of the settlement.

Stayed at the Tallow & Thorn Inn. Owner is Bram Tallow. Human, middle-aged, missing part of his left ear. Friendly enough but seems nervous when discussing the bell tower.

Met Warden Elira Thorne at the town hall. Human woman, dark hair, scar across chin, wears an old military-style breastplate.

She hired us to investigate the disappearance of three bell-ringers over the past fortnight.

Important information from Elira:

- Three people have disappeared.
- All were employed to ring the old bell tower.
- Each disappearance happened on a night when the bell rang at an unusual hour.
- Nobody admits to ringing it.
- Blue lights have been seen around the tower.
- Local guards refuse to investigate after dark.

Payment offered: 150 gold each on completion, plus anything recovered from whoever is responsible.

NPCs:

- Elira Thorne — Warden of Brackenford. Quest giver.
- Bram Tallow — Innkeeper at Tallow & Thorn.
- Old man called Dorrik Fen mentioned by Elira. Supposedly knows the old waterways beneath town.

Investigated the bell tower that evening.

Found:

- Scratches on the inside of the bell housing.
- Blue wax on the staircase.
- A strange symbol resembling a circle with three vertical lines.
- The bell rope had been cut and tied back together.

Combat: Several dead figures emerged from the cellar beneath the tower. Looked like drowned corpses, possibly reanimated. One had a blue light inside its chest.

Initiative notes:

1. Niko
2. Drowned 1
3. Kael
4. Karma
5. Drowned 2
6. Idris
7. Faelan

Echo was useful here. Managed to flank the first creature while my physical body held the staircase. The creatures seemed resistant to ordinary intimidation and did not retreat.

Faelan identified some sort of alchemical residue on their bodies. Niko suggested they had been dead for a long time.

Recovered a small brass token from one of the creatures. Three waves engraved on one side.

Outstanding questions:

- Who is ringing the bell?
- Why are the bell-ringers disappearing?
- What is the blue light?
- What does the three-wave symbol mean?